PLAYER REPORT

KOTA KUDO

POSITION: **CENTER BACK**

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D.O.B: 13.08.2003, 22 years
Nationality: Japan
Position: Centre Back
Number: 2
Foot: Left
Height: 1.80 m
Weight: 72 kg
Status: Development Loan

OVERALL SUMMARY

- Kota Kudo “No-nonsense defensive center back” is a 22 year old centre back who plays for J1 League club Fagiano Okayama.
- Kudo is known for being physically brave, disciplined, and reliable in duels.
- He profiles a strong defensive centre back as he prioritizes stopping attacks, clearing danger, and win aerial duels. He does not contribute heavily to build-up play.
- He is the type of player whose contribution is best appreciated through careful observation, as many of his actions can be easily overlooked without close attention.

STRENGTHS

- Great anticipation of both ground and aerial duels.
- Anticipates player movements well and frequently intercepts passes.
- Accurate, fast, powerful shot passes.
- Aggressive and brave.
- Defensively reliable: clearances, marking, and tackling.

AREAS OF IMPROVEMENT

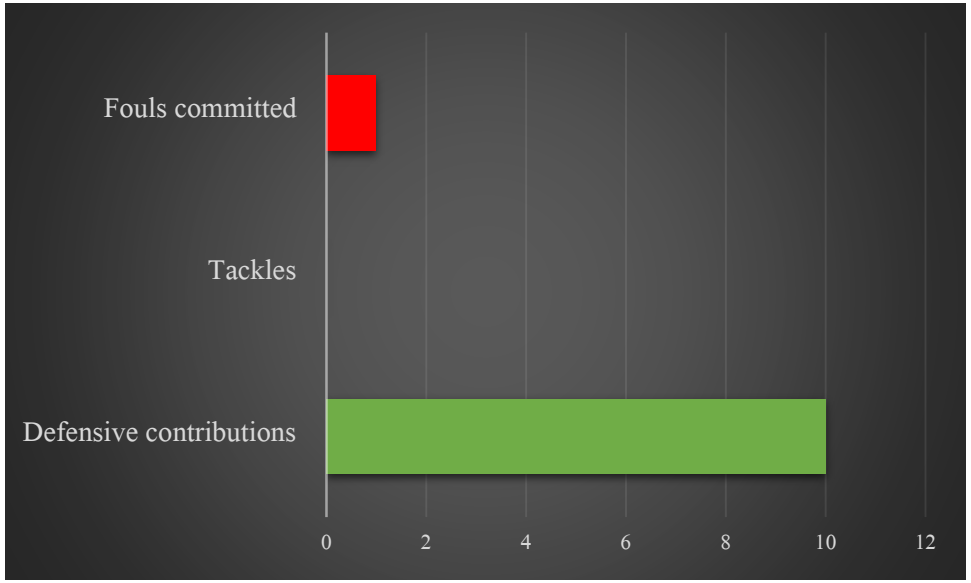
- Ball progression.
- Decision-making when building from the back.
- Defending large spaces.

Games Watched:
- Fagiano Okayama 1-0 Kyoto Sanga F.C.

Minutes Watched: 97 Minutes
Date: 11.03.2026

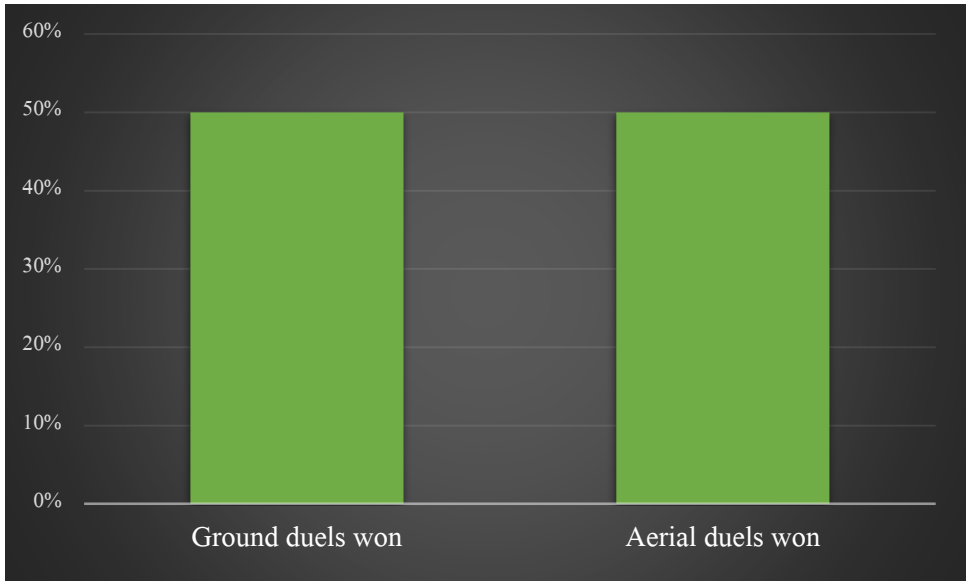
LEAVING POSITION TO PRESS

Kudo displays a great sense of timings in leaving his position to press opponents without affecting defence shape. His clever use of pressure tends to push attackers to make quick decisions or errors, and the team to be able to recover and defend well in general.



DEFENSIVE DUELING

Kudo always manages to win duels on the ground and on air with good positioning, timing, and physicality. A level-headed guy under pressure, he defends the high-risk areas, prevents unneeded fouls and gets back on his feet very soon after difficulty which gives the defensive outfit its due balance and reliability.



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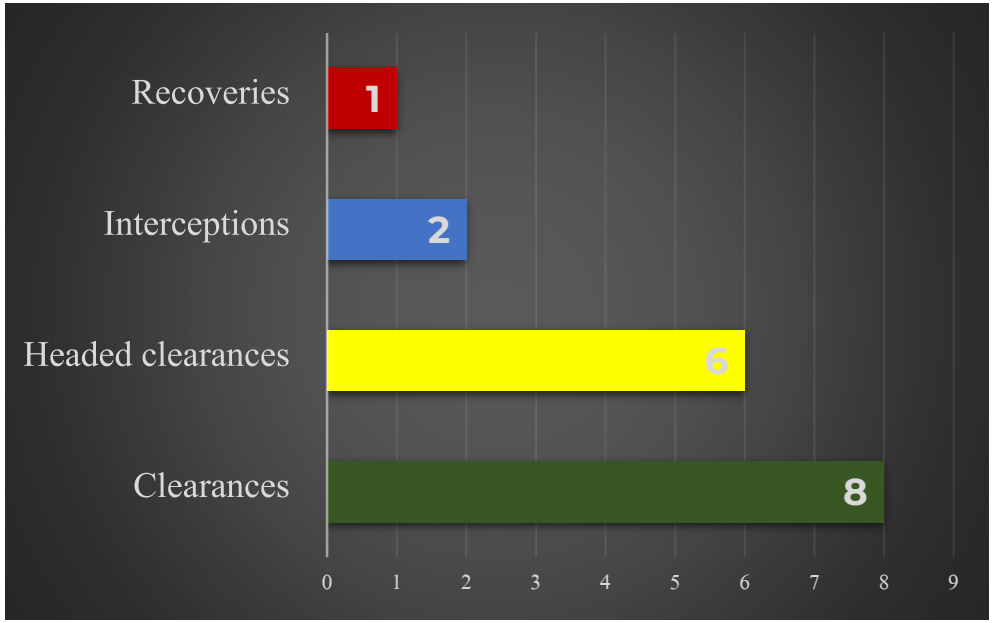
DEFENDING SPACE IN BEHIND

The player always follows forward runs of attackers, being aware of possible through balls and avoiding break-aways at the back of the defense lines. Through explosive acceleration, he makes space smaller within a short time period, restricting the options of attack and compelling the opponent to make hard-pressed decisions.



DEFENDING CROSSES

Kudo stands at the best position at the penalty area to minimize the shooting angles and aerial threats. He communicates with his teammates effectively on crosses to make sure that the team is well marked, to arrange the defensive line, and to reinforce a team against approaching balls.

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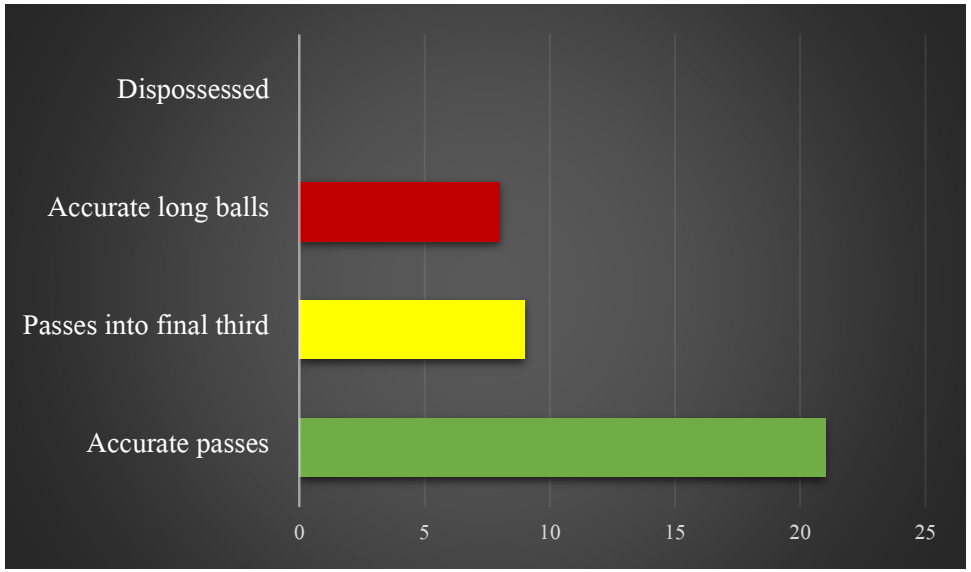
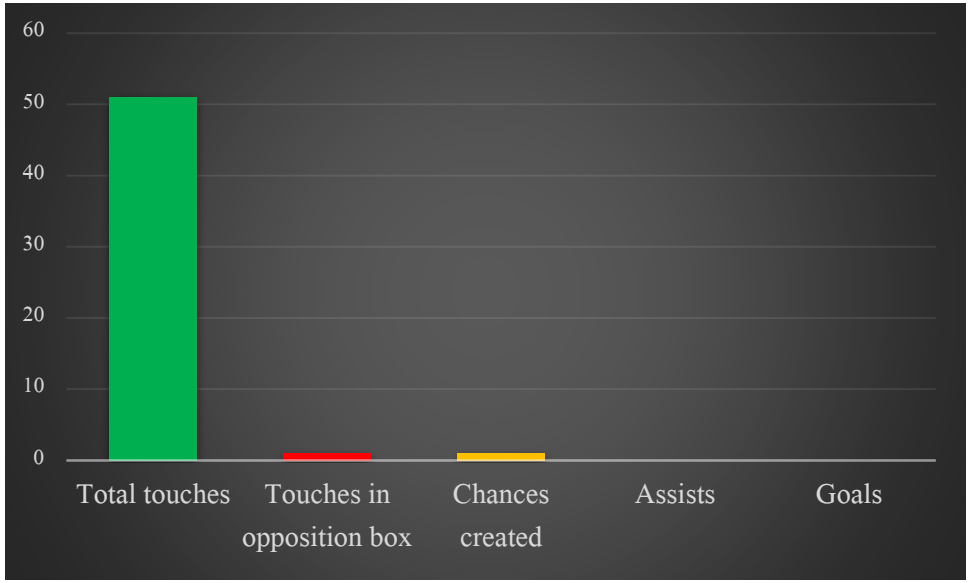
BUILD-UP UNDER PRESSURE

When Kudo is under pressure, he recognizes safe ways to pass the ball, preserving the structure and possession of the team. He values short, internalized passes, does not risk taking the ball in the face of pressure, and is very effective in passing the ball, diffusing the number of turnovers and guaranteeing the offensives move safely through the defensive to the midfield lines.



BUILD-UP AGAINST LOW BLOCK

Kudo looks around the field to see gaps and passing lanes and is patient to take opportunities of gaps against tight formations. Through selective line-breaking or long-range passing he extends defensive lines, opens up room to colleagues and facilitates transitioning efficiently during tight situations holding on to control.



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PLAYER PROFILE SUMMARY

POSITION & ROLE

Kota Kudo is an organized player, a center-back, who is good at organizing the defensive line and providing space behind, as well as working on the development of the game in the back. His approach is more about positioning, predictive and intelligent ball delivery instead of a simple use of physical dominance.

SCOUTING INSIGHTS

- Good at reading through balls and enabling minimal space behind the defensive line.
- Places himself well on crosses and manages colleagues within the penalty area.
- Intelligently applies pressure, driving attackers off of central danger zones without obstructing defensive shape.
- Duels well, applies timing, strength and flying to win duels.
- Supports serve to accumulate under pressure, provide safe passes and selective breaking of lines using long balls.

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INVESTMENT & STRATEGIC FIT

Kudo has good value with regard to his projected value which is the potential to develop coupled with defensive stability. The player may be smoothly assimilated, which offers continuity and stability on the defensive line, as well as the support of the depth of the squad and defensive strategy in the long term.

SUMMARY

Kota Kudo is a hard-working, tactical-minded goalkeeper who possesses good positional awareness, aerial skills, and ball playing skills. Although his impact can be enhanced through additional distribution and anticipation, he fits perfectly with the philosophy of developing the club in the defensive recruitment aspect.